

37 Wordweb
We're all of course fans of the written word, and when it comes to this subject, no other software is an English Nerd's friend like Wordweb. It's a instant dictionary and thesaurus. Simply hit [CTRL]+[ALT]+[W] after selecting a word from any app and it'll give you meanings, alternative words and many other options. We would recommend it to anyone even remotely interested in writing better, increasing their vocabulary, and knowing correct pronunciations.



34 Recuva
From the creators of CCleaner comes a guardian angel software of sorts for those 'oops' moments when you delete a file and suddenly realise it was the wrong one. And we're not talking of the soft deletes that can be recovered from the recycle bin. Recuva is also good at recovering data from crashed hard drives.



30 Google Talk
Like Yahoo! Messenger of yesteryear, Google talk too seems to be clinging on for a place in today's world of website integrated and all in one messengers. Gtalk faces its biggest competition from the web UI integrated chat found in Gmail itself. Still for those who have the installed app, have rated it decently high amongst messengers



36 SpeedFan
Being gamers, overclockers, and in general performance enthusiasts, we need to keep an eye on our computer's vitals like our life depended on it. Since system temperature is the most important measure to keep track of, SpeedFan is an important utility. SpeedFan is an hardware monitoring software that monitors voltages, fan speeds and temperatures in your PC. It can access S.M.A.R.T. info and show hard disk temperatures too and even dynamically change fan speeds accordingly, thus reducing noise.



33 Thunderbird
Thunderbird is one of the biggest open-source success stories in the world today. A robust, cross-platform mail client such as Thunderbird has rarely been seen even in the commercial space. It's easy to set-up, customisable, and has a lovely UI. What more would you want?



29 foobar2000
If you like your music served in a clutter-free, distracting less manner, the ultra-lite player foobar2000 is your best bet. Beneath its Plain Jane looks lies a powerful media library organiser, Audio CD ripper, music format converter and support for numerous plug-ins developed on its free-for-all SDK by a dedicated community. All in all a neat little 3.1MB package.



28 VirtualBox
Anytime you want to run something from a different platform a quick way is to configure a virtual machine. While initially VMWare was an often opted for option, Sun Microsystem's VirtualBox seems to have overtaken the former virtualisation wizard. It's installed on almost all of our systems.



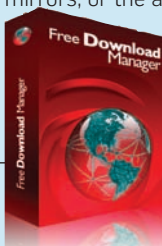
32 Picasa
Picasa is a photo editing cum photo management hybrid that is a favourite amongst most people - from your regular Joe to even techies. The application comes with some really nice and unique features which include, web gallery integration, face detection, and geo-tagging images. We like it for its simplicity.



27 Open / Libre Office
It may not be all visual splendour and productivity glory like MS Office, but its still is a commendable work-in-progress. While there is a long way to go before the project comes anywhere close to acceptable, it is still the best free option out there.



26 Free Download Manager
Extensions like DownThemAll have arrived, and besides those days of downloading large files via http on slow connections have long gone. Yet a lot of people still use download managers even today. Features such as finding mirrors, or the ability to make multiple connections to a server are much appreciated.



35 Avast
Generally we refrain from playing favourites with antivirus suites based on detection rates and performance. The reason is the ever-changing malware landscape which results in a constant battle wherein



AV makers are always trying to keep ahead of malicious coders. Avast over the years has proven itself in actual deployment scenarios and hence finds a place in our list based on the votes received.

31 Spybot Search and Destroy

There is enough awareness these days about malware and people do install an antivirus but when it comes to spyware, most are still clueless. Spybot is



a specialised product that aims at protecting users

privacy from malicious data gathering programs known as spyware. It even blocks adware programs along with cleaning usage tracks - an interesting feature if you use a machine that's shared by other users

25 Internet Explorer

Internet Explorer is regarded as the browser you use to download a better browser. This clearly reflects in the ranking it has received amongst the other browsers in the list. We still like to keep it around as a failsafe right? When a particularly prickly website refuses to open in Chrome, who do you turn to - good old (or bad old) Internet Explorer.

